

[Return to Search](#)

Original Page: 29

Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1982-1983

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Place Coverage

Kade area, Central Kalahari Game Reserve, Botswana

Section Title(S)

(2) Kinship Categories and Proximity/Contact • (3) Generation and Proximity/Contact

Comparing the ratio of the dyads in contact with that of the dyads in proximity, it is to be noted that in the dyads of parent-child-in-law contact seldom occurs, irrespectively of sex, in spite of relatively frequent occurrences of proximity.

[209](#)
[Proxemics](#)

[602](#)
[Kin Relationships](#)

In summary in comparing close consanguineous or affinal relations, it is evident that contact is far less frequent between the siblings of the opposite sex than between those of the same sex. This is also true for the relations between siblings-in-law (i.e., ego and ego's sibling's spouses or spouse's sibling). Furthermore, a similar but weaker tendency is evident for the number of dyads in proximity. Although the parent-in-law and child-in-law are very often in proximity with each other, physical contact is strongly avoided between them.

[209](#)
[Proxemics](#)

[602](#)
[Kin Relationships](#)

(3) Generation and Proximity/Contact

Generally, it has been accepted that the joking-avoidance relationship is closely related to both sex and generation. Namely, 'reserved' or 'respectful' behavior is required toward the persons of an adjacent upper generation, while relaxed behavior is tolerated toward those of alternate generations. In the above section where correlation between kinship and proximity/contact was examined, it is shown that there was a tendency to avoid being in contact with consanguineous or affinal kins of the opposite sex, but the correlation

[121](#)
[Theoretical Orientation](#)

[561](#)
[Age Stratification](#)

between the degree of proximity/contact and the generation has not yet been fully clarified. In this section, it will be examined whether there exists significant difference in the number of dyads in proximity or in contact, among the dyads belonging to the same, adjacent, and alternate generations.

Usually some contradiction arises between the relative positions individuals occupy in the genealogy and the absolute age order among them. For instance, in the genealogy of the subject group, kk-7, the eldest daughter of an old woman (be-2), belongs to the same generation as that of unmarried adolescent males such as KI-11, KI-14, and TB-15. Moreover, she belongs to lower generation than that of unmarried adolescent females such as km-15 and gu-16, even though she herself is a mature female (about 40 years old) with 3 children.

121

Theoretical Orientation

Thus in this section the generations induced from the relative positions occupied by the residents in the genealogy are distinguished from the generation based on age grades which were induced from both the age order among them and their physical appearance. The former is designated as the 'genealogical generation' and the latter 'biological generation'. Based on each of the genealogical and biological generation, the dyads of residents are classified into three kinds of generational categories, i.e., the same generation, the adjacent generation, and the alternate generation. When classifying the dyads into biological generation categories, the kinship relations are completely ignored, and all the dyads of residents are included. On the other hand, all male-male dyads are classified into genealogical generation categories, while only the male-female and female-female dyads of consanguines and primary affines are classified into genealogical generation categories. This procedure is induced by the fact that the genealogical distance does not exert strong influence on the occurrence of proximity/contact among male-male dyads while proximity/contact hardly occurs among the male-female or female-female dyads of distant kin. It is also expected that within the range of such close kinship relations as consanguines and primary affines, the San themselves are aware of the genealogical generation irrespectively of absolute age order among them.

121

Theoretical Orientation

128

Organization And Analysis Of Results

Table 11 shows the total number of male-male, male-female, and female-female dyads belonging to each (a) genealogical generation categories and (b) biological generation categories, and the number of dyads in proximity or in  30

128

Organization And Analysis Of Results

Table 11(a). Distribution of dyads for which proximity or contact was observed at least once among genealogical generations

209

Proxemics

561

Age Stratification

Generations	Number of dyads	Dyads in proximity	Dyads in contact
<u>Male-male dyads</u>			
Same generation	54(46.2)	31(45.6)	19(45.2)
Adjacent generation	53(45.3)	32(47.1)	23(54.8)
Alternate generation	10(8.5)	5(7.3)	0(0.0)
Total	117(100.0)	68(100.0)	42(100.0)
Significant level(χ^2)	-	ns(0.1645)	ns(4.4275)
<u>Male-female dyads</u>			
Same generation	43(42.6)	18(30.0)	2(11.1) ⁺
Adjacent generation	48(47.5)	35(58.3)	14(77.8)
Alternate generation	10(9.9)	7(11.7)	2(11.1)
Total	101(100.0)	60(100.0)	18(100.0)
Significant level(χ^2)	-	ns(3.8920)	0.05(7.6783)
<u>Female-female dyads</u>			
Same generation	25(46.3)	14(40.0)	11(47.8)
Adjacent generation	21(38.9)	17(48.6)	10(43.5)
Alternate generation	8(14.8)	4(11.4)	2(8.7)
Total	54(100.0)	35(100.0)	23(100.0)
Significant level(χ^2)	-	ns(1.4142)	ns(0.7174)

Table 11(b). Distribution of dyads for which proximity or contact was observed at least once among biological generations

For the symbols '+' and '-', see the notation of Table 9.

Biological generation	Number of dyads	Dyads in proximity	Dyads in contact
<u>Male-male dyads</u>			
Same generation	41(35.0)	19(27.9)	15(35.7)
Adjacent generation	56(47.9)	36(52.9)	19(45.2)
Alternate generation	20(17.1)	13(19.2)	8(19.1)
Total	117(100.0)	68(100.0)	42(100.0)
Significant level(χ^2)	-	ns(1.5078)	ns(0.1597)
<u>Male-female dyads</u>			
Same generation	82(33.5)	28(33.7)	6(28.6)
Adjacent generation	126(51.4)	40(48.2)	7(33.3)
Alternate generation	37(15.1)	15(18.1)	8(38.1) ⁺⁺
Total	245(100.0)	83(100.0)	21(100.0)
Significant level(χ^2)	-	ns(0.6554)	0.02(8.8391)
<u>Female-female dyads</u>			
Same generation	44(36.7)	17(31.5)	9(28.1)
Adjacent generation	61(50.8)	32(59.3)	20(62.5)
Alternate generation	15(12.5)	5(9.2)	3(9.4)
Total	120(100.0)	54(100.0)	32(100.0)
Significant level(χ^2)	-	ns(1.6037)	ns(1.7435)

31 contact in respective generation categories. Only for male-female dyads, are significant chi-square values obtained from the distributions of number of dyads in contact among both of the genealogical and biological generation categories. Namely, contact is apt to be avoided between males and females belonging to genealogically the same generation ($\chi^2=4.8153$, $p<0.05$, $df=1$). At the same time, contact tends to frequently occur between males and females belonging to biologically alternate generations ($\chi^2=7.3516$, $p<0.01$, $df=1$).

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